

Dangerous music downloads

The Recording Industry Association of America (RIAA), filed 261 copyright lawsuits across the country against Internet users, accused of illegally downloading and sharing songs. According to one estimate, 60 million Americans



participate in file-sharing networks and half of them are teenagers.

The RIAA stated that it has named the people who paid for the household Internet account as the defendants. It also clarified that it would not sue those who admitted to the deed, and promised to delete the songs off their PCs.



snapshot

Logitech has shipped **500 million** mice. These were sold with an estimated **55 per cent** of the **900 million** PCs shipped over the last **two** decades.

Source: The Associated Press

You can't steal my TV!

A new technology being developed at Britain's Centre for Networking Telecommunications Research will soon be available for household devices such as Televisions, DVD players, computers, etc., so as to enable them to



inform police when they are

stolen. These devices will be fitted with special microchips that will keep track of their location and normal proximity to each other, and will alert the police whenever there is a unexpected change.

Nigel Linge, professor at the Research Centre, said that they expect the pilot project to run within six months, using hybrid wireless and mobile phone technology, and would be accurate up to a metre. He also stated that work is on to install global position technology in cars for speed regulations.

Windows smartens Motorola

Microsoft is finally launching the Motorola MPX200 Smart Phone. Powered by Microsoft Windows Mobile, it can connect to computers and communicate with almost every MS application. The phone itself has pocket PC versions of MS Outlook, Windows Media Player, Internet Explorer and Microsoft Messenger. This is a 2.5G phone with two sleek screens—the



resolution of the inner screen 176 x 220 pixels at 65,536 colours. It has an expandable memory card of up to 1 GB, and comes with a USB connector for data transfer and battery charging. It is expected to be available in October through Orange in Europe, and other distributors throughout Europe and Hong Kong. It will also be available in US through AT&T later this year.

quoteworthy

"We are in many ways humbled by the developments of the last few weeks"

Steve Ballmer, CEO of Microsoft, commenting on the recent rash of attacks exploiting vulnerabilities in the family of Windows. Microsoft now intends to make all the necessary improvements in its software to thwart viruses and other types of attacks.

"Silicon Valley will more closely resemble Detroit."

Larry Ellison, CEO of Oracle, commenting on how he believed IT is rapidly becoming a commodity and that eventually, the IT industry would consist of a few giants such as IBM, Sun Microsystems, Oracle, Microsoft, and a number of small specialised IT vendors.

"100W for a desktop is OK."

Pat Gelsinger, Intel CTO, indicating that the Prescott, may dissipate more than 100 Watts of power. Now who's making bigger fans?

tomorrow's technology

Out of thin air...

One of the most promising new concepts presented at the SIGGRAPH 2003 Emerging Technologies show in San Diego, USA is the fog screen. The display works on two major components—a laminar (non-turbulent) air-flow, and a thin sheet of a fog that is injected into the non-turbulent airflow. The fog is the actual viewing surface,

and works by reflecting light projected onto the fog screen by a projector to the observers. As long as the air-flow remains non-turbulent, the images reflected off the viewing surface remain crisp. The transparency of the screen can be controlled, and the images can be projected from either the front, or the rear. Its developers, the Acad-

emy of Finland, are convinced that it's feasible. They believe that the quality and size of the screen, among other parameters, will be dramatically enhanced over the next few weeks. Interestingly, the screen is dry, silent and non-breakable; and it can create virtual environments around audiences that are composed rapidly by a series of screens.